

Onboarding & Activation

Long-Tail Volume — No Named CSM, No 1:1 Kickoff

Purpose

Get high-volume, lower-revenue accounts to real activation without individual project management — the single highest-leverage move at this tier, since a mass early-abandonment problem is a real retention event even though no individual account is large.

The Activation-First Principle

Everything at this tier is designed around one question: did the account complete a defined first-value event within a set window? Without a defined activation event, health scoring at scale is just guessing.

Step-by-Step Process

- 1. Automated welcome sequence** Triggered at signature — no live handoff call. Sales logs basic account data (industry, use case) so the sequence can be lightly personalized rather than fully generic.
- 2. Self-serve golden-path setup** A standardized configuration with minimal decision points — fewer choices, faster time-to-first-value, less room for the customer to get stuck and quietly disengage. This replaces individual implementation project management entirely.
- 3. Cohort onboarding webinar** Weekly or biweekly, one live session covering many accounts at once. This is the highest-leverage single addition at this tier: fully self-serve onboarding has the worst early-abandonment rate, and a scheduled group session provides a real human touchpoint at near-zero marginal cost per account.
- 4. Training — cohort model** Group webinars, an on-demand video library, and in-app walkthroughs. No individual training exists at this tier — the knowledge base has to be genuinely good, because it's doing the job a person does everywhere else.
- 5. Office hours** Weekly, opt-in, drop-in, no booking required. Self-selects for customers who actually have a question, which is a far better use of team time than proactive outreach nobody asked for.

Support Channel Stack — One Knowledge Base, Three Surfaces

- **Chatbot** — first-line triage; always-visible "talk to a human" escalation; anything unresolved becomes a real ticket with the chat transcript attached, so the customer never re-explains themselves
- **Docs/knowledge base** — organized by task ("how do I..."), owned by the pod CSM, updated whenever a support ticket reveals a content gap
- **In-app** — contextual tooltips and walkthroughs at the point of need, a setup progress checklist, and adoption nudges shown exactly where they're relevant

What Sales Tells the Customer

Frame what they get, never what they don't: a dedicated support team, live onboarding sessions, open office hours, and a team monitoring account health behind the scenes. If a prospect pushes on wanting a named contact, the honest answer is that it's a team-based model at this tier — with the option below as the real alternative.

Customer Communication Principles

Scaled does not mean anonymous. Even without a named CSM, every touchpoint should hold to the same standard: - **Timely** — automated doesn't mean delayed; nudges and responses fire on the schedule the customer expects, not whenever the system gets to it - **Personalized by use case and lifecycle stage** — a brand-new account and a two-year veteran account get different messages, even from the same automated sequence - **A clear route to a human** — every automated touchpoint states plainly how to reach a person, and that route actually works when used

The Named-CSM Add-On Option

A defined, priced line item ("Dedicated Success Manager") that manually promotes an account to Tier 3-equivalent service regardless of its organic revenue. Gives Sales a real answer when white-glove service is a genuine deal requirement, and turns what would otherwise be an absorbed cost into incremental revenue. Price and scope are defined up front, not renegotiated deal by deal.

Artifacts

- Automated welcome sequence template
- Golden-path configuration spec
- Cohort webinar schedule and standard curriculum
- Support-channel content map (chatbot ↔ docs ↔ in-app, one source of truth)
- Named-CSM add-on pricing sheet